

City of Waterville

Committee Charge: Parks and Recreation Advisory Committee

This document is the formal charge to the committee named above as adopted by the City Council and the Mayor to take effect on the date noted. It sets out the parameters of purpose, membership, authority, conduct of business, reporting, and sunset provisions. It may be modified from time to time only by vote of the Council. A copy of this charge is provided to all who apply to serve on this committee.

Purpose.

The Committee shall serve as an advisory body to the Parks and Recreation Director and the City Council. The Committee is tasked with evaluating and recommending strategies to enhance recreational programming and facilities within the City, ensuring alignment with community needs and fiscal responsibility.

Membership.

Membership shall be 7 members and comprised of a City Councilor, a representative from Alford Youth Community Center, a representative from Friends of Quarry Road, a representative from Waterville Public Schools and two citizens at large and the Parks and Recreation Director. Members should possess experience or demonstrate a strong interest in enhancing and expanding recreational opportunities in Waterville. All appointments to the Committee shall be made by the Mayor with the approval of the City Council.

Scope of Authority.

The Committee shall prepare findings and recommendations for consideration by the City Council on the following matters:

1. Recreation Program Development and Fee Structure:

- Prioritize increasing participation among Waterville youth by identifying strategies to keep program cost affordable for local families, while maintaining program sustainability.
- Work with the Alford Youth Community Center (AYCC) and Friends of Quarry Road (FOQR) in exploring opportunities for new and expanded recreation programs, such as the Green Street Park Summer Recreation program.
- Work with AYCC and FOQR to evaluate and recommend appropriate fee structures, with the understanding that programs should be self-supporting, exclusive of administrative costs.

2. Facility Improvements and Community Needs:

- Assess and identify areas for improvement within the City's recreational facilities.
- Provide recommendations to address unmet recreational needs in the community, including consideration of the financial impact on property taxpayers.

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3. Funding Opportunities:

- Investigate and identify potential grants and alternative funding sources to support recreation programs.
- Present viable funding options to the City Manager and City Council for further action.

4. Bond Fund Utilization:

- Advise on the most effective use of remaining 2022 Recreation Bond funds for improvements to the City's parks and recreation facilities.

5. Economic Impact Study Review and Implementation:

- Review the findings of the Economic Impact of Outdoor Assets study completed in July 2025.
- Identify actionable recommendations from the study and develop strategies for implementation and present them to City Manager and City Council for further action.

The Committee is not authorized to make promises or enter into verbal or written agreements purporting to represent the City.

Conduct of Business.

The Committee is an official body of the City. As such, it is subject to Maine's Freedom of Access Act, 1 M.R.S. § 403, and must meet in a location accessible to the public, allow the public to attend its meetings, publicly post the dates and times of meetings, and keep minutes for the public record. The Committee shall meet monthly at a time determined to be convenient to its members. No member of the Committee may participate in a matter before the Committee where the member has a conflict of interest. After disclosure, the remaining members shall make a determination as to the participation of the conflicted member. The Committee may review the Ethics Ordinance or consult with the Solicitor regarding conflict-of-interest questions. The Committee will meet with experts and consultants and can engage with similarly situated groups at the state and local level.

Reporting.

The Committee shall report on its findings and make recommendations to the Council twice a year (summer/winter).

Sunset.

This committee shall sunset on December 31, 2027.